

HOLYFAITH ACADEMY
English Literature - (English Paper - 2)

(15CE)

Time: 2 Hours

SEM - I

Full Marks: 80

Instructions:

Answers to this Paper must be written on the paper provided. You will not be allowed to write during the first 15 minutes. This time is to be spent in reading the question paper. The time given at the head of this Paper is the time allowed for writing the answers. The paper has four sections. Section A is compulsory – All questions in Section A must be answered. You must attempt one question from each of the Sections B, C, and D and one other question from any Section of your choice. The intended marks for questions or parts of questions are given in brackets [].

1 SECTION A

(Attempt all questions from this Section.)

1.1 Question 1

Read the following questions and choose the most appropriate response from the choices given below. (Please do not copy the question – simply write out in correct serial order the appropriate word or phrase.) [16]

1. Choose the option that lists the sequence of events in the correct order for Act 1 of Julius Caesar.
 - (a) The Soothsayer warns Caesar.
 - (b) Cassius persuades Brutus.
 - (c) Flavius and Marullus scold the commoners.
 - (d) Casca describes the storm and omens.
 - (a) 3, 1, 2, 4
 - (b) 1, 2, 4, 3
 - (c) 4, 3, 1, 2
 - (d) 3, 2, 1, 4
2. Select the option that shows the correct relationship between Statement 1 and Statement 2 from Julius Caesar.

Statement 1: Cassius says, "The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, But in ourselves, that we are underlings."

Statement 2: Cassius believes that men have the power to change their destiny.

 - (a) 1 is independent of 2
 - (b) 1 is a contradiction of 2

- (c) 1 is an example of 2
 - (d) 1 is the cause of 2
3. The character of Oliver Twist in "Oliver Asks for More" can be best described as:
- (a) rebellious and bold
 - (b) innocent and desperate
 - (c) cunning and clever
 - (d) happy and content
4. "Is it me?" I asked. (With the Photographer)
Which of the following words best describes the speaker's mood in this line?
- (a) disbelief and surprise
 - (b) sadness and frustration
 - (c) pleasing and playful
 - (d) none of these
5. Which of these statements is NOT true about Bonku Babu from "Bonku Babu's Friend"?
- (a) He was a teacher by profession.
 - (b) He had a life-changing encounter with an alien.
 - (c) He had very high respect in his village.
 - (d) He was often the target of jokes.
6. The beast in "A Work of Artifice" is primarily a metaphor for:
- (a) the growth of a gardening
 - (b) the skill of a craftsman
 - (c) the rumour in "The Boy Who Broke the Bank"
 - (d) the bank manager in "The Boy Who Broke the Bank"
7. The rumour in "The Boy Who Broke the Bank" spread quickly because:
- (a) Nathu was angry and grumbling about his unpaid wages.
 - (b) the bank manager made a public announcement.
 - (c) a newspaper published a false story.
 - (d) Nathu deliberately started it to get revenge.
8. Skimbleshanks: The Railway Cat is described as being essential for:
- (a) moving the train engine
 - (b) serving meals on the train
 - (c) the central theme of the poem

- (d) catching mice at the railway station
- 9. The central theme of the running of the Night Mail:
 - (a) joy of childhood memories
 - (b) sorrow and nostalgia
 - (c) excitement of travelling to new places
 - (d) the disillusionment of adulthood
- 10. In Julius Caesar, Act 1, Scene 3, the violent storm and strange omens are interpreted by Casca as signs of:
 - (a) a great celebration to come
 - (b) the gods' anger at the state of Rome
 - (c) changing weather patterns
 - (d) Caesar's imminent coronation
- 11. Mr. Bumble's reaction to Oliver's request for more food was one of:
 - (a) shock and outrage
 - (b) sympathy and understanding
 - (c) amusement and laughter
 - (d) indifference and neglect
- 12. The threat to Sripati during Ang gave Bonku Babu was:
 - (a) a ride in his spaceship
 - (b) a promise to punish his tormentors
 - (c) self-confidence and liberation from fear
 - (d) a promise to iron out all
- 13. The phrase "the nature of things" in "A Work of Artifice" is used ironically to highlight:
 - (a) how natural the bonsai tree looks
 - (b) how the tree's natural growth has been artificially stunted
 - (c) the gardener's love for nature
 - (d) the tree's original habitat
- 14. The climax of "The Boy Who Broke the Bank" occurs when:
 - (a) Nathu gets his pay
 - (b) Sitaram finds a job for Nathu
 - (c) a panic-stricken crowd gathers outside the bank
 - (d) the bank manager gives a statement

15. In "I Remember, I Remember", the poet's childhood is portrayed as a time when his heart was:
- (a) very heavy and full of care
 - (b) light and joyful
 - (c) full of ambition
 - (d) sorrowful and envious
16. Cassius's conversation with Brutus in Act 1, Scene 2 reveals his skill as a:
- (a) cunning manipulator
 - (b) loyal friend
 - (c) cunning manipulator
 - (d) faithful subject of Caesar

2 SECTION B

(Answer one or more questions from this Section.)

DRAMA (Julius Caesar by William Shakespeare)

2.1 Question 2

Read the extract given below and answer the questions that follow:

Cassius: For once upon a raw and gusty day, The troubled Tiber chafing with her shores, Caesar said to me, "Darest as I was, I plunged in And bade him follow. So indeed he did. The torrent roar'd, and we did buffet it With lusty sinews, throwing it aside And stemming it with hearts of controversy.

1. What challenge did Caesar give to Cassius, and how did Cassius respond to it? [3]
2. Whom does Cassius compare himself to when he saves Caesar from drowning, and why? [3]
3. What does this incident reveal about Caesar's physical strength and dependence on others? [3]
4. Why does Cassius stress Caesar's weaknesses in this scene? What is he trying to achieve? [3]
5. Do you think Cassius's arguments against Caesar are based on genuine concern for Rome, or are they motivated by jealousy? Give reasons for your answer. [4]

2.2 Question 3

Read the extract given below and answer the questions that follow:

Casca: When these prodigies Do so conjointly meet, let not men say, "These are their reasons; they are natural." For I believe they are portentous things Unto the climate that they point upon.

1. List any three unnatural occurrences described by Casca in his speech. [3]
2. Why does Casca refuse to believe that the prodigies are "natural" events? [3]
3. How do the prodigies reflect the political situation in Rome at that time? Whom did Casca meet after Cicero? [3]
4. How does Cassius interpret the strange signs differently from Casca? [3]
5. Do you think Casca's fearful reaction to the prodigies makes him a weak character, or does it show his loyalty to Rome? Give reasons. [4]

3 SECTION C

(Answer one or more questions from this Section.)

PROSE - SHORT STORIES (Treasure Chest - A Collection of Poems and Short Stories)

3.1 Question 4

Read the extract from Ruskin Bond's short story, "The Boy Who Broke The Bank" given below and answer the questions that follow:

The news spread through the bazaar with the rapidity of forest fire. From the general merchant's, it travelled to the shop, circulated amongst the customers, and then spread with them in various directions, to the betel-seller, the tailor, the free vendor, the jeweller, the beggar sitting on the pavement. Old Ganapati the beggar, had a crooked leg. He had been squatting on the pavement for years, calling for alms.

1. How did the news spread through the bazaar, and who were some of the people it reached? Why is the speed of the news compared to a "forest fire"? [3]
2. What do the references to different shopkeepers and a beggar reveal about the social life of the bazaar? What careless remark by Nathu set the chain of rumour in motion? [3]
3. How did the townspeople's trust in gossip contribute to the so-called "collapse" of the bank? [3]
4. What human weaknesses is Ruskin Bond exposing through this humorous story? Do you think such incidents still happen today? Explain. [4]
5. Who are Mrs Srivastava and Mrs Bhushan? Why went they to the market? What are they discussing? [3]

3.2 Question 5

Read the extract from Charles Dickens' short story, "Oliver Asks for More" given below and answer the questions that follow:

'She is dead,' said the doctor. 'Yes, poor dear,' said the old woman, as she took the child away from its dead mother. 'Poor dear.' 'She was a good-looking girl,' said the doctor, as he put on his hat and gloves. 'Where did she come from?' 'She was brought here last night,' said the old woman. 'She was lying in the street. She had walked a long way and her shoes had holes in them. Nobody knows where she came from, or where she was

going to.' The doctor raised the dead woman's left hand. 'The usual story,' he said. 'I see that she has no ring on her finger. She wasn't married. Good night!'

1. What did the doctor declare about the young woman, and how did the old woman react? Why does the doctor conclude that the dead woman was not married? [3]
2. What does the doctor's casual remark – "The usual story" – reveal about his attitude towards the woman's death? [3]
3. How did the woman with holes in her shoes end up at the place where she died? [3]
4. What role does the old woman play in highlighting the fate of the young woman? [3]
5. Do you think the story reflects society's indifference towards the struggles of poor women? Give reasons for your answer. [4]

4 SECTION D

(Answer one or more questions from this Section.)

POETRY (Treasure Chest - A Collection of Poems and Short Stories)

4.1 Question 6

Read the extract from T.S. Eliot's poem, "Skimbleshanks: The Railway Cat" given below and answer the questions that follow:

You may say that by and large it is Skimble who's in charge
Of the Sleeping Car Express.
From the drivers and the guards to the bagmen playing cards
He will supervise them all,
more or less. Down the corridor he paces and examines all the faces
Of the travellers in the First and the Third;

1. Who is in charge of the Sleeping Car Express, and how does he maintain control? [3]
2. Why do the passengers remain quiet when Skimbleshanks is around? How does Skimbleshanks' behavior reflect qualities of discipline and authority? [3]
3. Mention three duties performed by Skimbleshanks that prove he is indispensable to the train. [3]
4. How does the absence of Skimbleshanks affect the departure of the train? Describe it. [3]
5. Do you think Skimbleshanks is portrayed more like a strict inspector or a loyal servant of duty? Support your answer with examples. [4]

4.2 Question 7

Read the extract from Thomas Hood's poem "I Remember, I Remember" and answer the following questions.

I remember, I remember, The fir trees dark and high; I used to think their slender tops
Were close against the sky: It was a childish ignorance, But now 'tis little joy To know
I'm farther off from heav'n Than when I was a boy.

1. What did the poet as a child imagine about the fir trees' tops? Why does the poet call his childhood thought about the trees "a childish ignorance"? [3]
2. How does the contrast between childhood imagination and adult realization reflect the theme of lost innocence? [3]
3. Mention three happy memories of childhood described by the poet in the poem. [3]
4. How does the poet's tone change when he recalls his childhood in comparison to his present life? [3]
5. Do you think the poem suggests that adulthood brings disillusionment? Give reasons to support your answer. [4]